VERBAL

Critical Reasoning

(Strengthening, Weakening & Wrong assumptions)

Assignment 02

hitbullseye

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 1

The need for knowledge of the constitution and functions, in the concrete, of human nature is great just because the teacher's attitude to subject matter is so different from that of the pupil. The teacher presents in actuality what the pupil represents only in posse. That is, the teacher already knows the things which the student is only learning. Hence the problem of the two is radically unlike. When engaged in the direct act of teaching, the instructor needs to have subject matter at his fingers' ends; his attention should be upon the attitude and response of the pupil. To understand the latter in its interplay with subject matter is his task, while the pupil's mind, naturally, should be not on itself but on the topic in hand. Or to state the same point in a somewhat different manner: the teacher should be occupied not with subject matter in itself but in its interaction with the pupils' present needs and capacities. Hence simple scholarship is not enough.

It can be inferred from the paragraph that:

A) simple scholarship is lop-sided in its focus
B) simple scholarship might overlook the subject matter and focus purely on the student
C) simple scholarship, with a narrow focus, might not place enough emphasis on the student's needs
D) simple scholarship will always be lopsided in nature because of its ambiguous stand on problems

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 2

A being whose activities are associated with others has a social environment. What he does and what he can do depend upon the expectations, demands, approvals, and condemnations of others. A being connected with other beings cannot perform his own activities without taking the activities of others into account. For they are the indispensable conditions of the realization of his tendencies. When he moves he stirs them and reciprocally. We might as well try to imagine a business man doing business, buying and selling, all by himself, as to conceive it possible to define the activities of an individual in terms of his isolated actions. The manufacturer moreover is as truly socially guided in his activities when he is laying plans in the privacy of his own counting house as when he is buying his raw material or selling his finished goods. Thinking and feeling that have to do with action in association with others is as much a social mode of behavior as is the most overt cooperative or hostile act.

It can be inferred from the paragraph that:

A) In our social world, one's thinking, feelings and actions cannot stand in isolation to actions of others
B) In our social world, thinking, feelings and actions of an individual are driven by motivations and thoughts of others
C) In our social world, thinking, feelings and actions of a person cannot stand in isolation to those of others
D) In our social world, thinking, feelings and actions of a single person are juxtaposed retrospectively to those of others

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 3

A recent spate of industrial accidents has forced employers to take up more expensive insurance policies for their employees. This has meant that the cost of running businesses has gone by for these industries, and in order to keep a check on their expenses, employees have been laid off. This in turn has placed greater amount of pressure on existing workforce.

If the above information is correct, then which of the following proves that despite the reduction in employees, the cost of operating these businesses will continue to increase?

A) Since the life of a worker is at stake, the cost of insurance premiums is pretty high
B) The reason for industrial accidents is very hard to establish
C) The chances of accidents increase as workers are placed under additional workload
D) Since most industries are not focused on innovation and streamlining, accidents are inevitable

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 4

When industrial units steal electricity by using corrupt practices, and not paying their actual dues, a domino effect is set-up in the whole system. The loss in revenue forces state governments to increase rates of industrial electricity supply, which in turn leads to higher burden on those who were paying their dues in the first place. This eventually forces even more industrial units to steal electricity and cause higher loss to the exchequer.

The above chain reaction could not come into being unless which of the following were true?

A) An increase in electricity rates forces business to get aggressive and earn higher revenues
B) Industrial units stealing electricity cannot be forced to stop their thefts unless fines are heavily increased for their thefts
C) Some methods for detecting electricity theft can be effective at times, but generally they lack consistency to be always effective
D) When the governments decide on electricity rates, they do not take into account the possible amount of electricity theft they would have to face

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 5

It is generally believed that careful discussions and reasoning should precede high-level decisions in an organization. However, a recent survey found something different altogether. In comparison to the senior managers in the company, who adopt the conventional mode of deliberative decision making, most company CEOs took a far higher number of important decisions unilaterally (generally based on their experience) rather than calling for board meetings or meetings of senior managers. This clearly shows that clear, quick and unilateral thinking at the top is far better and more effective than long-drawn out considerate decision making.

The argument above depends on the assumption:

A) For their decisions, CEOs adopt clear, quick and unilateral thinking and senior managers adopt long-drawn out considerate decision making
B) Long-drawn out considerate decision making costs the organization in the long run
C) The seeming unilateral decisions taken by CEOs are actually based on experience which they have gained and these play the same role as the deliberations carried by senior managers for their own decisions
D) Decisions of CEOs are more effective than those of senior managers

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 6

An increase in the level of serotonin levels in the human body is known to significantly enhance the mood of the person and in some cases, help people overcome depression. Serotonin taken orally does not pass into the pathways of the central nervous system, because it does not cross the blood–brain barrier. However, tryptophan and its metabolite 5-hydroxytryptophan (5-HTP), from which serotonin is synthesized, does cross the blood–brain barrier. These agents are available as dietary supplements, and may be effective serotonergic agents.

Which of the following can be correctly inferred from the statements above?

A) Individuals who do not consume enough tryptophan can develop depressive tendencies
B) Individuals who consume tryptophan can metabolize enough serotonin and do not run the risk of depression
C) Consumption of serotonin laced foods can help cure depression in some cases
D) Tryptophan is an effective agent that can help cure depression in some cases

DIRECTION for the question: *The question has a text portion followed by four alternative summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text.*

Question No. : 7

An increase in the median income of the middle class does not cause average levels of education for the middle class to go up. If they did, then countries with the highest median income of the middle class would also have the highest levels of education for this class. In fact, when the median income of the middle class is made suitably comparable for different countries (accounting for inflation, currency fluctuations and purchasing power parity), there is no such co-relation.

Which of the following can be correctly inferred from the statements above?

A) Countries with the highest median income of the middle class do not have the highest levels of education for the middle class
B) It is difficult to reliably compare the education and income levels of one country with another
C) A reduction in the median income of the middle class of the country will not necessarily lower the average level of education for the said class
D) Countries with low levels of education for the middle class have comparatively higher levels of median income for the middle class

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 8

The government mandated an increase in minimum wage of employees in industrial units. Because of the increase in wages, XYZ industries had to increase the wage of majority of its employees (who were working on minimum wage). Despite this increase in wages, the profit of XYZ industries has gone up.

Which of the following definitely help resolve the paradox in the argument above:

I. The raw material cost for XYZ industries has gone down by more than 30% in the last one year.
II. The excise duty and sales tax levied by the government has gone down substantially.
III. XYZ industries has re-positioned its brands and now targets the ultra-rich for its products.
IV. The majority products built by XYZ industries are for people who earn minimum wage.

A) I, II & III B) II, III & IV C) I, II & IV D) All of the above

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 9

Alcohol companies have been complaining for a very long time that they have to pay the highest amount of taxes, yet they are not allowed to directly advertise to their clientele. They believe this is inherently unfair and actually causing a loss of revenue to the government, as by allowing them to advertise, the overall sales of alcohol will go up even further, and bring in greater revenue for the government. The government does not pay heed to this demand as it does not see merit in the argument of the alcohol companies.

Which, out of the following, justifies the action of the government?

A) The government's responsibility is not only to earn profit but also to ensure that its citizens are healthy and wise.
B) The government can clearly see through the fact that an increase in alcohol consumption is not actually possible.
C) The government is the one that bears the cost of patient care due to alcohol abuse, and increasing existing levels of alcohol consumption fractionally will lead to an exponential increase in alcohol abuse.
D) The government is bound by its ethical duty to perform the functions of the state, and its function is definitively not to act on behalf of the companies.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 10

The coming-in of private airlines in the aviation sector has actually had one unintended consequence: the delays at the top 5 airports in the country have increased by 40%. The aviation ministry took up a project to assess the reasons for this delay and came out with the proposal of constructing a new terminal and runaway at each of these airports.

The argument of the aviation ministry is based on all of the following assumptions except:

A) The existing airports have the additional land available for considerable development to take place.
B) From the time the private airlines began operation, the number of airplanes in the country has increased.
C) The existing passenger load at the top 5 airports necessitates an increase in increase in the number of slots available for flights.
D) Existing airports in the top 5 cities do not have the required number of slots that can be allocated to all airlines.

QNo:- 1 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
In the given question, the answer can be inferred from the lines: Or to state the same point in a somewhat different manner: the teacher should be occupied not with subject matter in itself but in its interaction with the pupils' present needs and capacities. Hence simple scholarship is not enough.
This leads us to ***option C****.*

Option B reverses the actually given fact.
Option A is insufficient and
Option D is not related to the given paragraph.

QNo:- 2 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
The paragraph has one simple outcome: in a social environment, an individual cannot act, think or feel without considering others. This simple fact is illustrated by ***option C****.*

Option D commits the mistake of using the word 'retrospectively' (In a manner contemplative of past events).
Option A commits the mistake of only quoting the actions of others, and
Option B brings in 'motivations', something which is not mentioned in the paragraph.

QNo:- 3 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
Option C *is the correct answer.*
In the given case, we need to stick to the line of reasoning adopted in the paragraph. The reasoning is:

- *Because of accidents, workers have to be insured with more expensive policies.*
- *Because of insurance, the cost goes up.*
- *Because of the increased cost, workers have to be let go.*
- *Because of the reduction in workers, the workload increases.*

If we add option C to the above, that is the chances of accidents go up when the workload increases, we see that a chain reaction is set in motion as more accidents will take place and this will further increase insurance costs.

QNo:- 4 ,Correct Answer:- *D*

Explanation:-
The first thing that we need to understand here is the question:
- It effectively wants us to identify the assumption of the argument in the given case.
- It wants us to identify the piece of information that is required to bring in the said domino effect/chain reaction in the question.
Keeping this in mind, we can see that ***option D*** *is the best fit.*
It highlights the crucial assumption of the argument.
How to establish it is correct?
Reverse it.
If governments took into account the possible thefts, then the total revenue they generate initially would account for the loss in revenue. Thus, the governments would not have to raise rates in the first place.

QNo:- 5 ,Correct Answer:- *D*

Explanation:-
In this case, we need to find the missing link.
The arguments tell us that CEOs take decisions unilaterally and senior managers take the course of deliberative decision making.
Then the conclusion tells us that the work of the CEOs is more effective.
The argument never provided a fact for this conclusion, and this clearly exposes the gap in the argument, which ***option D*** *fills up.*

QNo:- 6 ,Correct Answer:- *D*

Explanation:-
In the given case, ***option D*** *is the only valid inference.*
We know tryptophan helps produce serotonin, which in turn helps cure depression in some cases. This connection is highlighted by option D.

Option A is something we cannot conclude. We are not sure whether not consuming tryptophan causes depression.
Option B is again ruled out as the paragraph does not state that producing enough serotonin precludes depression.
Option C is incorrect as serotonin is not directly metabolized in the body and this means that having foods containing serotonin cannot be synthesized by the body directly.

QNo:- 7 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
In this case, we are told that there is no reliable relationship between the median income and average level of education for the middle class and the increase/decrease in income levels does not have an impact on education levels. This sentiment is highlighted by ***option C****.*

Options A and D can be ruled out as no direct co-relation can be found between the median income and average level of education for the middle class. These two options in fact give a particular extreme co-relation.
Option B is irrelevant in the given case (goes against the given facts, figures for comparison have been derived in fact).

QNo:- 8 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
Let us analyze the options one at a time to find a definite resolution for the paradox:
Option I*: This reduces the cost, thereby increasing margins and profit.*
Option II*: This again reduces the cost incurred by XYZ, and thereby increases profit.*
Option III: This does not have definite outcome; this option does not state that it has increased its sales.
Option IV*: This helps resolve the paradox as it implies that people whose wages are being increased are the same as the consumers, thereby implying increased sales for the company.*
Hence ***option C*** *is correct answer.*

QNo:- 9 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
The key aspect that we keep in mind here is that the proposal of the companies is not to be shot down on moral or ethical grounds. The conclusion of the argument is that the government does not see merit in the argument of the alcohol companies, that is it does not find their proposal worth it. This, in other words, means that it does not see the opportunity as one where it will be able to generate increased revenues. Why would be that so?
That will happen if the government sees some roadblock or some obstruction to the increase in revenues.
This is clearly implied by ***option C****, which focuses on the increase in costs for the government.*

QNo:- 10 ,Correct Answer:- *B*

Explanation:-
Option B
In this case, we need to identify three assumptions made by the aviation ministry.
One of the options will not be the assumption. In this case, that option is option B.
Remember the conclusion of the aviation ministry:
a new terminal and runaway are needed at each of these airports, that is capacity expansion needs to be carried out.
How can such a recommendation be made? It depends on three assumptions:
1. Sufficient availability of land for expansion
2. Sufficient consumers available for expanded capacity.
3. Existing infrastructure not enough to accommodate planes (implied by option D).
The number of planes in the country does not affect the given conclusion.